



Geir Engdahl

Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer, AI

\$170M+ (2025)

Revenue

Oslo

HQ

01 Who You're Meeting

Geir Engdahl — Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer, AI, Cognite.

In role: Co-founded Cognite in 2016; appointed CTO of AI in May 2025

Today: Owns Cognite's AI-first technology strategy, working directly with the hyperscalers and large language model providers to get agentic AI value into industrial customers' operations.

A working engineer with a competitive-programming pedigree, which is rare at this level. He founded Snapsale, a classifieds AI startup acquired by Schibsted, and was a senior software engineer at Google building AI capability for advertising systems, before co-founding Cognite. He holds a master's in computational science from the University of Oslo and a silver medal from the International Olympiad in Informatics.

Career: Co-Founder & Chief Technology Officer, AI, Cognite; Co-Founder and technology leadership, Cognite; Senior Software Engineer, AI for advertising systems, Google; Founder, Snapsale (acquired by Schibsted)

Education: MSc Computational Science, University of Oslo; Silver medal, International Olympiad in Informatics

The company: The clearest signal of where this market is heading: an independent industrial-AI platform just sold to a strategic incumbent (Schneider Electric) for 18x revenue, consolidating into AVEVA.

What they sell: Cognite Data Fusion (unified industrial data model + knowledge graph) and Atlas AI (generative/agentic AI for industrial workflows), covering plant operations, asset management and engineering.

02 Where The Company Sits

Closest comparable to Sand on the digital-twin/industrial-data angle specifically. Its \$3.1B exit is the reference point for what a well-executed independent player in this space can be worth.

03 Talking Points

- Ex-Google engineer and IOI medallist — genuine technical depth; an architecture conversation will go further than a capability one.
- He owns the hyperscaler and LLM partnerships, so model choice, data residency and cost control sit with him.
- Co-founder still in a hands-on technical role nine years in, which is a good signal about product continuity.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- About to lose independence entirely — folding into AVEVA under Schneider Electric, with integration risk for customers and staff
- Glassdoor sample size is thin (169 reviews) for a company this size, limiting confidence in the 3.2 rating
- Post-acquisition roadmap and brand continuity are open questions as of the deal announcement

04 GIP Context

GIP: No connection found. Cognite's investor base (Aker ASA, TCV, Accel, Saudi Aramco) has no disclosed GIP tie, and no GIP portfolio company appears among its named customers (Aker BP and others).

BlackRock: No direct stake in Cognite today. Indirect exposure is coming: once Schneider Electric's ~\$3.1B acquisition of Cognite closes, Cognite becomes part of a company where BlackRock is the largest shareholder (7.93% of Schneider Electric, per...)

Others at Cognite: Girish Rishi (Chairman & Chief Executive Officer); John Markus Lervik (Co-Founder & Chief Strategy Officer)

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